



Xiaomi invests Rs 3500 crore in India

Xiaomi is expected to use the investment in the white goods sector, like water purifiers, washing machines, and refrigerators. <https://digit.in/apr19-63>



US plans to isolate Huawei globally

US warns Germany against allowing any Chinese company to participate in building a 5G network. <https://digit.in/apr19-64>



SUPERCOPS VS SUPER VILLAINS

This show has had a long history, and has undergone many name changes over the years. Originally it started as Shapath, then

transformed into SuperCops vs Supervillains, before finally ending up as Khoonkar, which was a full blown exploration of Werewolves and Vampires in an Indian setting. The episodes from SuperCops vs Supervillains are the really fun ones to watch, and a good introduction to western science fiction tropes for a vernacular audience. In the first episode, the baddies are ninjas, and every small thing about them that are taken for granted as common knowledge are explained in detail, from their clothing, to their costumes, to their weapons. There are aliens, robots and villains with superpowers, which are inspired from famous works from around the world. GIFs from 90s video games had better special effects, but this is a series that is so bad, that it is good.



CHI AND ME

Chi and Me is a series that shares a similar setting to ET. Sachin is a young boy living in Dalhousie who's father Avi, disappears in mysterious circumstances

- which can be interpreted as an alien abduction. Sachin is constantly drawn to Dalhousie lake, where he keeps witnessing some strange phenomena, exasperating the local watchman in the process. A jerry rigged game controller attached to a screen serves as some kind of futuristic device with unknown purposes, but seems to track the strange occurrences. Avi's friend, Rahul, a space scientist working in Mumbai, brings Sachin to the big city. Sachin is isolated in the big city, and is not initially accepted by Rahul's two children, Aastha and Ria. Then the ET shows up, who goes by the name Chi. Initially, Sachin is scared of Chi too, but gets scared and hides him when the other kids show up. Eventually, Chi and Sachin develop a friendship, and the alien starts manifesting powers.



INDRADHANUSH

This one is another science fiction series on DoorDarshan, that had high production values and featured Karan Johar and Urmila Matondkar in a group of

young adults. One of the most entertaining parts about the series is just watching the overacting by these young actors. The kids build a computer at home, which is possessed by an

alien prince from the Andromeda galaxy, who is represented by a pair of deep blue eyes. The computer also has the ability of transporting people forwards and backwards through time, and this gives rise to all kinds of interesting situations. Yes, one of the characters ends up meeting his own grandfather, and the kids are surprised by the amount of food they can buy for a Rupee. The alien prince gives time travellers a "remote" which is kind of like a cellular phone that works across time, which allows the. Just the extended title sequence is an experience, featuring computer generated imagery and electronic music.



KARISHMA KAA KARISHMA

Karishma Kaa Karishma is a remake of Small Wonder, and most of the setup is the same. Vickram is a robotics scientists who

creates Karishma, and the family adopts her as their own daughter. Karishma is an experiment to see if she becomes more human like over time. The family also has a bunch of very friendly and nosey neighbours, along with a daughter Sweetie who has a major crush on Vikram's non robotic son, Rahul. Karishma is so robotic in actions and speech, that it is a miracle that nobody finds out her secret, which Vikram, his wife Sheetal and Raul desperately try to keep. In every episode, Karishma rescues her family and friends from all kinds of situations, using advanced technologies that look suspiciously like magic. When she immobilises bandits from a distance, it is difficult to tell if she just used some kind of photon beams or fairy dust. In any case, if you enjoyed Small Wonder as a kid, this is the same show, set in India.



ViR: THE ROBOT BOY

ViR: The Robot Boy is a relatively recent animated series, where technology and magic exist together. Episodes of the show can be seen on the Wow Kidz

Action channel on YouTube. Apart from the titular character who is a very advanced robot with many qualities that make for an intelligent and adventurous young boy. Packed within him are a bunch of technologies and gadgets that he uses throughout the show. His best friend is a jinn by the name of Gintu, who can use his magical abilities to get the gang out of tricky situations. Then there is Imli, who is the brains of the operation but is also brave at the same time. This is an action comedy show, where ViR has to take on a bunch of baddies along with his friends and Chulbul, a pet donkey that looks like the Donkey from Shrek. The supervillain in the show is actually called Mad Max (not kidding). While there are some supernatural enemies, including dragons, blob monsters and a ghost monkey, most of the baddies are robotic animals. 